Catra's Past

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/32983168.

Rating:
Mature

Archive Warning:
Graphic Depictions Of Violence

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Original Characters, Luna (Catra's Mother), Apollo (Catra's Father), Razz (She-Ra), Huntara (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Catra's Past, First Meetings, Not Overally Graphic but Warning Nessecary, Preqeul Story, TATEOTW Prequel Story, catradora, Kid Fic, Past Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Catradora growing up, Life in the Horde (She-Ra), Fluff and Angst, Battlefield

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Part 1 of Together at the End of the World - Preqeul/Extra/Alternate Stories

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by Midnight_Owl2

Summary

We all know that Catra was found in a box by Adora in the Fright Zone when they were little. But how exactly did Catra end up in the Fright Zone to begin with? How did her story begin? Where did she come from? What events happened that lead to her growing up in the Fright Zone as a Horde Soldier?

Notes

This fic is a prequel story to my original fic: Together at the End of the World. This story can be read as a stand alone but I'd advise reading the original fic to understand the other stories within this collection.

TATEOTW readers - This prequel story links with two chapters of Together at the End of the World: Chapter 4 (Alone) where Catra tells Adora about her past and Chapter 9 (ADORA!) when Catra and Razz meet for the 'first time'. Hope you enjoy.

See the end of the work for more notes

It was a cool autumn afternoon in the Whispering Woods. Magic flows through like it always has, but Madame Razz remembers a time when the magic was stronger and the world was at peace, *or so it seemed*. The First-Ones destroy most of that memory and took with them one of the bravest warriors even known. Now all that remains is a devastating war between those who believe they are pure and those who rebel. A new champion awaits but there is still a while to wait before they arise.

Razz was waiting outside her hut, waiting for something that she wasn't quite aware of just yet. Her mind was foggy but she could sense that something pure evil was to happen today, but what?

A small tugging at the end of Razz's robes brought her back to the reality. She looks down to find a small bundle of fluff, with sharp claws, a swaying tail, huge cat like ears and heterochromic eyes staring at her robes ready to pounce on them once more.

The small magicat was Catra, or at least that's who Razz knew her to be. Catra is a name that Razz was aware will be given to her very soon, by someone who she will hold dear to her heart forever. The person who will give this magicat her name is someone Razz will help guide on her new journey within the next decade or so, just like she did many, *many* years before with her dear Mara. How these two will meet Razz does not know, but something tells her it will be something to do with the events that keep fading from her mind.

"Catra dearie, what are you doing?" Razz asks as she looks down at the small kitten who stares back and giggles at her in response. She holds a loose rag of Razz's gown tightly in little claws, proud of capturing her 'prey'.

Razz bends down and gently picks up the small magicat, scratching her behind her ears. The small magicat responds by emitting the loudest purr Razz has ever heard.

“Pie?” The young magicat eventually responds. They young kitten was very skilled when it came to communicating. She is fast learned and has picked up on some of the most complicated words that her species say. Pie however was taught by Razz.

“Oh dearie we have to wait for Mara. I bet she can’t wait to see how big you’ve grown.”

The young magicat in her arms looks at her with a confused look. They have only ever heard of this person called Mara but have never seen her. Seeing the kittens confused look and cute twitching ears, Razz caves…

“Well I suppose a slice of pie why we wait for your mother to get back wouldn’t hurt. I’m sure my Mara won’t mind, after all she was a bit of a rule breaker when growing up.”

The young magicat giggles in her arms and pounces out of her grip, walking on all fours into the hut. Razz smiles to herself. Razz has been alone for many years… to many years that she can’t seem to recall. Time passes differently for Razz, it can be… well… *confusing.*

Madam Razz moves to follow the young magicat inside, but she has to steady herself with her trusty broom as another vision floods her mind. Madame Razz knows all too well that what she is seeing may have happened before but something about this feels different…

Razz’s vision is interrupted when she feels a familiar tugging on her robes. She looks down to find a concerned young Catra looking back at her.

“Is Razz okay?”

Razz looks down at Catra, a weak smile appearing across her face. Who would have thought that this little ball of fur would have stumbled into her hut about a year ago and became Razz’s friend. Unfortunately, Razz is worried that if her vision is as it seems, this may be the last time she sees Catra for many years. Not wanted

to worry the young magicat, Razz responds with her a phase she knows will lighten the mood...

“What dear, you’ll have to speak up I can’t hear you without my glasses on.”

That earns a giggle from the young magicat. Over the past year, despite Catra’s young age, she has come to learn that Razz can sometimes be confusing, or at least that’s what her mother says. Nevertheless, Catra likes Razz just the way she is.

Both head inside and have some pie: blueberry to be exact. The small kitten is a messy eater, blueberry going all over her face but it shows Razz that’s she clearly enjoys it. She attempts to lick the blueberry around her mouth off her face, magicats have incredibly long tongues, they always win the 'touch your nose with you tongue' games. After a few moments and full clean face later, Catra asks Razz about Mara…

“Tell me about Mara.”

The kitten beams up at Razz with wide eyes and a playful grin on her face…

“Pwease.”

Catra is still learning how to pronounce certain words, one being ‘please’. Razz can’t deny the child’s request and her cuteness makes her even more adorable.

“Alright dearie. I will tell you. My Mara was a warrior, a protector, a hero. She was known as ‘She-Ra – the Princess of Power’.

Catra watches Razz with amazement, carefully listening to her every word. The story of She-Ra fascinates her but also scares her. The princess of power has said to be a protector but mysteriously disappear from Etheria many years ago. The tales of her sheer size and power are enough to make young magicats fur stand on end. Deep down, Catra also imagines this She-Ra as someone beautiful, not that she’s sure what that word means, but

she’s heard her father call her mother beautiful many times so she assumes it must mean something good.

“She-Ra was the protector of Etheria, powerful, caring and courageous. Unfortunately the First-Ones wanted to control her power, to use her as their weapon. My Mara saw through their little act and rebelled against them. She realized that all she was taught was a lie. She was the chosen one, but not for the destiny that she was original sent on. She was the chosen one for a destiny that saved everyone. She was brave my Mara.”

Razz goes quite after a few moments and Catra realizes that’s the end of the story. She wants to ask what happen but she knows better than to not to.

The drape of the hut moves open letting in a beam of light, but a tall figure blokes part of the sun from entering. The figure that stands before them takes a few steps forward. She has a long tail and ears just like Catra’s but there are a few differences. Her fur is a silverish grey, her forearm stripes are white and she has piercing yellow eyes. She is wearing a purple robe that covers her chest and lower waist, black leather leggings that come up to her knees and wrap around the pads of her feet. Most recognizable of all is the crimson red mask that rests of her head.

“Afternoon Razz. How was your day… and how’s my little kitten doing?”

“Mommy.”

The young kitten leaps from her seat on one of the huts stools and leaps into her mother’s arms. Catra’s mom, Luna, immediately starts rubbing her cheeks against her kittens, a comforting and lovable action in magicats, and begins purring.

“How was your day with Madam Razz? I hope, you haven’t been causing too much chaos.” Luna jokes as her kitten settles in her mother's hold.

“I’ve had a good day. We made pie, Razz told me stories, and I made my first kill.”

The young kitten points to Razz’s robes where her claw marks are visible, Razz doesn’t seem to mind. Luna hums in approval, watching her kittens claws kneed into the fur surrounding her collar bone.

“Thanks for watching her today Razz. Apollo and I really appreciate it. This little one has been quite the handful recently, but we wouldn’t change it for the world, especially if it means we can keep our kingdom and our kitten safe.”

“Not a problem dearie. Me and Catra have had the best time haven’t we.”

Catra giggles and Luna rolls her eyes. She’s lost count of how many times she has told Razz that that’s not her kittens name but she knows Razz can sometimes get confused.

“What do you say to Madame Razz for taking care of you?”

“Thank you Razz.”

As Luna turns to leave, Razz’s mind is once again gifted with visions of what was to happen. That's when she see a figure in her mind, running from the flames, trying to escape from a new evil. Razz has to warn them…

“Oh Luna Dearie.”

“Yes Razz.”

Madame Razz went to speak but immediately forget what to say. *Why does this always happen to Razz? Think Razz think.* When nothing reboots Razz’s mind she thinks of something else to say.

“Hope you have a safe journey home.”

“We will Razz, we’ll see you soon. Have a nice night.”

Little did they know, soon would be a very long time away.

--

“Mommy?” The young magicat asks as she is held tight in her mother’s arms as they walk back home through the villages of the Kingdom of Half-Moon.

“Yes my Kitten.”

“Razz seemed to be forgetting stuff today. Is she okay?”

Luna has noticed this more and more frequently with Razz. She understands that Razz is… well… *ancient*, no one exactly knows how old she is, but some of Razz’s stories, especially more recent ones, are becoming quite concerning.

Recently, the Horde have been taking ground in Half-Moon territory. Unfortunately, the once proud princess alliance isn’t as strong as it once was and many are now turning on each other to protect their own. Queen Luna and King Apollo have been offered support from their allies in Brightmoon but they’d rather not concern them, especially with their Queen and King expecting a child of their own very soon.

Luna knew raising a child during the time of war would be difficult, but the news that they were expecting a kitten of their own after many years of trying was the light of hope they needed in this dark time. Catra’s arrival was a scary time. She was born early and magicat doctors feared for the new-born princess's life. However, Luna knew that her daughter would pull though, she was strong, powerful and determined even despite only being a few hours old. Call it instinct but Luna could feel it, she could sense it. Her kitten was strong, she would survive. The day Luna and Apollo were able to hold their kitten for the first time after her birth was the most magical day of their lives. They vowed to love

and protect her for the rest of their lives. She meant everything to them. They'd protect her with their lives, no matter the cost.

"Razz can sometimes get confused with the past and the present. Your father believes that she can actually see into the future. However, Razz has been around for a very, *very* long time and sometimes can get her stories muddled up."

"What about the story of She-Ra?"

"Now that one is a true story, in fact it's become legend. Unfortunately, the protector of Etheria hasn't been seen for many years. The last She-Ra was long before either me or you father were born. We were told stories about her when we were kittens."

"That long ago?"

"Yes."

"Wow, you and dad are really old."

Luna starts to laugh. Her daughter definitely has her father's sense of humour. Stars help her when she's a teenager or even finds a soulmate of her own. Luna can't begin to imagine that day but she knows all too well how quick they come and go.

"Wait till I tell your father you said that."

Both start to laugh as they enter the room that belongs to Luna and Apollo. There, standing on the balcony ledge sits another figure. He has broad shoulders and a kink in the tip of his tail, which is possibly the result of a battle injury. His fur is the same colour as the young magicats but it's slightly thicker, it also has a hint of grey due to his age. As he turns to face his visitors, it's clear to see that he has a pair of blue eyes and a happy smile appearing across his face.

"What do I owe the pleasure of meeting two beautiful magicats?"

"Dad!"

The young magicat practically squeals in her mother's arms and begins to wriggle until she is passed over to her father. Apollo cradles his daughter in a tight embrace, purring up a storm as he sways her side to side. His kitten is his pride and joy. The day his wife told him he was going to be a father he practically leaped with joy, some of the guards thought he had gone mad as they had never seen their king this excited about anything. Both Apollo and Luna had awaited the day they would become parents; their daughter is his greatest treasure."

"How's my little cute furball doing?" Apollo asks and his kitten giggles in response. He knows all too well that his daughter hates being called *princess*. The first time he called his kitten princess she hissed at him. Apollo can't stop smiling at the memory. Besides, furball suits her far better.

"I'm not cute." The young magicat protests but her giggles lets down her defensive stance.

"You can't deny it sweetheart. Your half of me and half your mother and she is the most beautiful Magicat I have ever met… *besides you obviously but don't tell her I said that*."

"Well *your* daughter definitely has *your* sense of humour. That I am certain of. Do you know she called *us* old earlier?"

"Well she isn't wrong."

Luna looks gobsmacked that her husband, *her soulmate*, just agreed with their daughter. It's worth it though to see their daughter in a fit of laughter. After the day they've had, their daughters' smile makes their day all the better.

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A few more hours pass. In that time young magicat has had a fulfilling meal consisting of her favourite food, fish sticks, a nice warm bath, *which she will admit she hates* and is now sitting in the middle of her parents on their bed. Her parents are quietly mumbling about something, but she's too tired to listen. In saying that she does pick up on a few words… *'Horde'… 'Evil'… 'Evacuation?'*. The young magicat has never heard any of these words before and quite frankly is too tired to ask what they mean. Eventually the tired young kitten starts to yawn and her eyes start to fall heavy.

"Come on furball. I think it's time for bed."

The young magicat simply lifts her arms up asking to be carried. After a goodnight kiss from her mother, the young magicat is carried to her own bedroom. Apollo makes sure his daughters tail is wrapped underneath her blanket before tucking her in tightly. The young magicat begins to purr, it's a lot lighter sounding than her fathers.

"Dad?"

"Yes sweetheart?"

"Can I ask you something?"

"Anything you want."

"What does beautiful mean?"

At first Apollo is a bit taken back by what his daughter is asking? He wasn't expecting that question, but he suppose he does say it around his wife and daughter a lot.

"Well my kitten, beautiful is a word I use to tell someone how I feel about them, that I love them. So, let me think how do I explain this… got it. I call your mother beautiful because I like the way she looks, not just on the outside but also on the inside. She's smart, pretty and she makes me happy. When I am with her I feel happy, I feel loved and I feel like my world is complete. It's

hard to describe what it means when beauty is found within your heart. Does that make sense?”

Apollo isn’t quite sure if he has answered his daughters question or has just confused her even more. Maybe this is something he should get Luna to answer.

“I think I get it…”

Apollo breathes a sigh of relief.

“But dad, you said loved. What does love mean?”

Now this question Apollo can answer easily.

“Love is a deep feeling that you feel for someone or something. You feel all sort of feelings when your with them, the best feeling is being happy and feeling like you can't live without them. Falling in love can be scary at first, but love makes you strong and gives you the courage you need to take on the world. I love you and your mother more than anything in this world. I will do anything to protect you because of the love I have for you.”

“Do you think I’ll ever find someone to love like the way you love mommy.”

Apollo chuckles at the young magicats remark. He can’t imagine his little kitten growing up. He wants her to stay this small forever, but he also wants her to find her own path and fall in love with the person she is destined to spend the rest of her life with. The fear of his little girl growing up is scary but watching them grow and learn is the most rewarding part of being a parent.

“You’re a bit too young to be worrying about that at the moment, but I know whoever you end up loving and loves you in return, will be the luckiest person alive.”

The young magicat starts to purr and her eyes slowly start to close. Apollo places a gentle kiss to the top of his daughters

head… “Sleep well little one”… and makes his way back to his room where he left his wife.

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The young sleeping magicat is startled awake by a thunderous roar outside. Her room is lit with shadows of an amber-red colour from the reflections outside her bedroom window. She wants to investigate but is too scared to move.

Her doors come crashing down, to which she notices her parents running to her side and immediately taking her to the secret tunnels of Half-Moon. She asks them multiple times what’s going on but isn’t answered, her parents attention is focused on the path ahead. Fires burst to life all around, the ground beneath her has been stained with a red colour and mysterious flags with an unrecognizable symbols fly high. Scared for her life, the young magicat simply hides her face against her mother’s chest, trying to block out the sounds of screams and firing machinery from her thoughts.

“Luna you need to get out of here. Take our daughter somewhere safe.”

“I won’t leave you Apollo.”

“I’m afraid you don’t have a choice. I’m not going to let them get to you or our daughter. Please, take her and stay safe. I’ll find you when this is all over. We’ll find each other. Do every lose sight of hope. I love you both so much.”

Luna and Apollo have tears in the eyes but they both know this is what must be done if they are to protect their kitten. They share a tender moment, afraid it might be their last, before Luna turns and makes her way further into the Whispering Wood, caring their timid kitten in her grasp.

"*Apollo.* How nice to see you again."

Apollo's fur stands on end, the shrill of a certain someone's voice sends an electrifying shiver down his spine. He turns with a low growl emitting in his chest. Only then does he recognize who this evil figure is...

"Light-Spinner? I thought- I thought you were dead."

"Foolish creature. Did you honestly think a bit of dark magic could stop me? I have learned to better understand its power and now with the power of the Black Garnet. I am unstoppable. With the Horde's help I will eliminate every last creature and Etherian that ever doubted me, starting with you and you kind."

"Not if I have anything to do with it!"

The battle rages on between Apollo and Shadow Weaver, both making significant impact. Unfortunately only one remains standing.

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Luna had been running for what feels like hours, loosing energy and strength with every step, but she has to go on, she's determined to keep her kitten safe. Unfortunately, time is against her and the Horde is moving at an alarming pace. There are a series of hidden stacks just outside of Half-Moons territory. The risk of leaving her kitten there is a great one, especially if her kitten was to be discovered but what choice does she have? She can't risk keeping her kitten with her, not with her serve injury on her leg slowing her down. She wouldn't be able to fight to protect them both if caught. Her daughter is strong, not matter what happens she will survive. They will find each other, no matter how long it takes. Luna promises herself that.

It isn't long before Luna arrives at the stacks of crates and boxes just outside of Half-Moon. They're out of sight and range of the Horde for now. Luna takes the opportunity to catch her breath and check on her kitten. Luna looks down at the trembling kitten in her arms, clearly scared from the ordeal. She doesn't want to leave her here but it's their best chances of survival. She vowed to protect her kitten at all costs and that's exactly what she'll do.

Luna leans down and starts rubbing her cheeks of her kittens head, scenting her, calming her down with her soothing purr. It's difficult to purr with everything going on but she'll do it to calm her kitten.

The young magicat starts to relax and releases her strong grip on her mother clothes. Luna is worried about what will happen next but she knows that this is her only reasonable option. She lifts the young magicat higher and places her into a foldable cardboard box, at least she'll be warm in there.

The young kitten looks back at her mother confused. Before she can say anything, her mother passes her the mask that was resting on her head…

"I need you to look after this for me. Can you do that?"

The kitten nods and nuzzles into her mother's touch as she strokes her cheek. Luna is on the verge of tears but she refuses to let them fall. She doesn't want her daughters' last memories of her to be with tears running down her face.

"How about we play a game of hide and seek? You hide and I'll seek. I need you to hide in here and stay very quiet okay. I'm going to go and tell your father that we're doing this okay. Then when he goes and hides I'll come and seek you both."

The young magicat makes a mewling noise. Luna hasn't her daughter make that noise since she was very little. Catra can sense that her mother's distress but nods in agreement at what her mother is asking of her.

Luna moves forward and places a gentle kiss to her kittens forehead before resting their head together…

“I love you so very much, never forget that.”

Luna gently closes the lid of the box, the only thing visible is her kitten shining eyes. Her tears finally start to fall.

“I’m sorry my kitten.”

Catra watches as she mother disappears in the distance. She clutches to her mother’s mask and waits for her return.

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Many hours pass and the dawn soon arises. Catra barely slept last night due to the noises she heard. She wanted to run but remembered what her mother said. So she waiting… and waited… and waited.

“We need to get these crates cleared so we can make a path to clear the debris in Half-Moon. See if there is anything we can salvage.”

Catra starts to panic. She doesn’t recognize the voices. Despite her young age she is ready to fight for her life.

A muscular, purple figure peers into the gap of the box Catra was in. She hisses at the creature, a light warning that she isn’t afraid to fight.

“Hey, hey it’s okay.” The creature says. Her voice is calm but Catra doesn’t risk it and punctures her claws through the front panel of the box.

“Feisty one aren’t we. Listen try and stay quite. I’m not going to hurt you. I’m going to help you okay?”

The figure smiles at the young magicat in the box and she eventually calms down. She knows her mother told her to stay put but right now she’s not sure what to do. However, if the sights and sounds from last night are anything to go off, she fears the worst. She might be young but she’s not stupid.

Catra starts to feel the box being moved and she sneaks a peek at what lies outside. Tree have fallen and mysterious figures in grey metal suits are walking around. The strange flags are visible up above, causing Catra to close her eyes in fear.

Suddenly the ground beneath her starts to move and the image of the place she once called home becomes no more than a desert land. The desert land eventually become a grey, red and smoggy area. The noise itself it deafening and causes to the young magicat to fold her ears against her head. Eventually, the box that Catra is hiding in is unloaded and placed into a dark corridor.

“Sorry but I’m going to have to leave you here. Try and not sneak off. If you see a scary woman with a red mask, then run. Sorry but I can’t do much more. Hopefully, I’ll see you around. I think you’d make good soldier. ”

Catra listens as the mysterious figure walks away, unsure of who this ‘red masked’ person is but she has no doubt she’ll find out one day.

Time doesn’t pass quickly, but the young magicat still can’t tell the time so she has no idea how longs it’s been. She has drifted in and out of sleep but the strange smells of this strange place have made it difficult to settle. She is rudely awoke from her sleep when she hears a series of heavy footsteps running past her and a series of dark giggles…

“Give it back. Shadow Weaver will kill me if I don’t finish it.”

“If you want it you’ll have to catch us first.”

Lighter footsteps start to pick up in speed before a figure trips in front of the box and lands flat on their face…

"Ouch." The figure says as she sits up and rubs the ride of her reddened cheek.

Catra quietly giggles to herself, but it obviously wasn't quite enough and the figure has slowly turned to face the box. Although not clearly visible to whoever or whatever this thing is, her shining eye make the young magicats presence obvious. The figure tilts their head slightly in curiously and moves closer to the box, causing the young kitten to hiss in response and move further towards the back of the box.

"It's okay. I'm not going to hurt you. I just want to say hi."

The figures tone is calm, reassuring the kitten inside the box that she may really just want to say hi. The figure smiles back and moves to kneel up to access the top of the box.

"You can come out if you want. I promise I won't hurt you. Wait, are you trapped in there?"

Suddenly, the top of the box starts to open. At first, the young magicat is scared, afraid that this may be the creature that the previous figure warned her about as part of her vision was blocked in the box. But no, the young magicat couldn't be more wrong. The young kitten looks up curiously at something that appears non-threatening but…*friendly?* The figure stands not much taller than the young magicat herself, in fact they look as though they might be the same age. The figure has a missing tooth between her front teeth, bright blonde hair and piercing blue eyes. The young kitten in the box makes no attempts to harm whoever this is, she doesn't appear to be a threat. Instead this young kitten looks up directly into her eyes and lets out a small mewling noise, this time it's a magicat greeting noise. The young girl smiles back at the young kitten in the box…

"Hi, I'm Adora. Do you want to be friends?"

End Notes

Hope you enjoy this prequel story about how Catra ended up in the Fright Zone. Please comment - let me know what you think. If you're new to my stories, why not check out the fic that this prequel story links with: https://archiveofourown.org/works/31439690/chapters/77760503

To my TATEOTW readers: What do you think of this prequel story? This is how Razz knew who Catra was when they meet in Chapter 9. It's also a reference to everytime Adora referred to the time she found/first met Catra. Hope you liked it.

Why not check out some of my other prequel/extra/alternate stories. For the rest of the fics in this collection I highly advise reading Together at the End of the World (link above) for them to make sense. Hope you enjoy reading them.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!